Avicenna
Functional Medicine

A FREE GUIDE

Autoimmune Health Blueprint

5 everyday steps to support your immune health

PLEASE READ THIS FIRST

- This guide is **general education for adults.** It is not medical advice, and it is not a treatment plan for you.
- **Reading it does not make you a patient.** Avicenna's care begins only after you book a visit and one of our clinicians agrees to treat you.
- **Keep following your own doctor's treatment plan.** Never stop or change a prescribed medicine on your own.
- **Ask your doctor before** you change your diet or start a supplement, especially if you are pregnant or breastfeeding, have kidney, liver or heart disease, or take blood thinners, steroids or medicines that suppress the immune system.
- **If you think you are having a medical emergency, call 911.**

Overview

Autoimmune conditions, such as lupus, Sjögren's, rheumatoid arthritis and inflammatory bowel disease, happen when the immune system attacks the body's own tissues. Medical care from your doctor is the foundation of treatment. Alongside that care, everyday habits like sleep, movement, stress relief and food choices can help you take a more active role in your health.

The Avicenna approach complements conventional medical care; it doesn't replace it. Everyone is different, and results vary from person to person.

1. Cut down on everyday toxins

Many people choose to limit their exposure to parabens, phthalates, BPA, microplastics, heavy metals, mold, herbicides and pesticides. Simple ways to start:

- Choose personal-care products labeled free of parabens and phthalates.
- Store and reheat food in glass or stainless steel instead of plastic.
- Fix leaks and mold in your home.
- Wash fruits and vegetables well, and choose organic when you can.
- Drink filtered water. If your home has well water, have it tested; your county health department can tell you how.
- When you can, walk, jog or bike away from busy roads.
- Drink water through the day. About 2 liters (8 cups) is a good goal for most adults, **unless your doctor has told you to limit fluids** (for example, for heart or kidney disease).

- Eat plenty of fiber, and aim for a bowel movement every day.

> **Sauna: ask your doctor first**
>
> Some people include sauna in their routine, but heat isn't safe for everyone. Check with your doctor first, especially if you are pregnant, have heart disease, low blood pressure or POTS, or a condition that heat makes worse. Keep sessions short, drink water with electrolytes, get out right away if you feel dizzy or unwell, avoid alcohol, and choose a clean, well-ventilated sauna.

2. Adopt an anti-inflammatory lifestyle

Healthy daily routines may help lower inflammation in the body:

- **Sleep:** aim for about 8 hours of restful sleep.
- **Stress relief:** meditation, slow breathing exercises such as box breathing, time with people you care about, and walks in nature.
- **Movement:** stay active in ways that feel good for your body. If you have joint pain, fatigue or a heart condition, ask your doctor or a physical therapist which activities are right for you.
- **Time outdoors:** sunlight helps your body make vitamin D, and many people feel better with time outside. But sun can trigger flares in lupus, and some medicines make skin burn more easily. **Ask your doctor how much sun is safe for you,** and protect your skin with shade, clothing and sunscreen.

3. Follow an anti-inflammatory diet

- Build meals around whole, minimally processed foods: vegetables, fruit, beans, nuts, seeds, fish and quality proteins. Choose organic and grass-fed when you can.
- Cut back on ultra-processed (junk) foods.
- **Foods many people like to include:** about 1 cup of blueberries and 1 cup of cruciferous vegetables (broccoli, kale, cauliflower) a day, about 2 cups of green tea a day (decaf if caffeine bothers you), and pomegranate (the fruit, or a small glass of 100% juice) a few times a week.
- **Thinking of going gluten-free or dairy-free? Talk to your doctor first.** If there's any chance you have celiac disease, get tested before you stop eating gluten: going gluten-free first can make the test come back falsely normal. If you stop dairy, make sure you still get enough calcium, especially if you take a steroid medicine such as prednisone.
- **Taking warfarin (Coumadin)?** Keep the amount of leafy greens and broccoli you eat about the same from week to week, and ask your doctor or pharmacist before changing your diet or adding teas or supplements.

4. Ask before you take supplements

Supplements can help some people, but they can also cause side effects and interact with medicines. More isn't always better. **Before you start any supplement, check with your**

doctor or pharmacist, and bring a list of everything you take. Supplements our care team often discusses with patients:

- **Vitamin D.** Ask whether you need a blood test and how much, if any, you should take. Too much vitamin D can raise blood calcium to unsafe levels. The safe upper limit for adults is 4,000 IU a day from all sources, unless a doctor advises more.
- **Omega-3 (fish oil).** Ask first if you take a blood thinner or have a heart rhythm problem.
- **Magnesium.** Ask first if you have kidney disease. Magnesium can also make some antibiotics and osteoporosis medicines work less well when they're taken close together.
- **A multivitamin.** Choose a brand with an independent quality seal, such as USP Verified or NSF.

Our clinicians can suggest doses that fit your health, your lab results and your medicines.

5. Consider advanced functional testing

Standard laboratory testing provides important information about your health, but selected functional medicine tests may offer additional insight into factors that could be contributing to inflammation. Depending on your individual history and symptoms, Avicenna testing may look at areas such as **nutritional status, metabolic health, gut health, environmental exposures and other relevant biomarkers.** Our clinicians decide which tests make sense for you, and your care team goes over the results with you. Functional tests add to the standard tests your doctor orders; they don't replace them.

Want a plan that's made for you?

Book a free 30-minute discovery call at **avicenna.clinic**. Avicenna offers telehealth visits for patients located in **Florida and Texas.**

THE PATIENT AND ANY OTHER PERSON RESPONSIBLE FOR PAYMENT HAS A RIGHT TO REFUSE TO PAY, CANCEL PAYMENT, OR BE REIMBURSED FOR PAYMENT FOR ANY OTHER SERVICE, EXAMINATION, OR TREATMENT THAT IS PERFORMED AS A RESULT OF AND WITHIN 72 HOURS OF RESPONDING TO THE ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE FREE, DISCOUNTED FEE, OR REDUCED FEE SERVICE, EXAMINATION, OR TREATMENT.

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Sources for the safety notes in this guide

NIH Office of Dietary Supplements: Vitamin D, Magnesium, and Omega-3 Fatty Acids fact sheets (ods.od.nih.gov) · NIH, National Institute of Arthritis and Musculoskeletal and Skin Diseases: Lupus (niams.nih.gov) · U.S. Food and Drug Administration: The Sun and Your Medicine (fda.gov) · NIH, National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases: Diagnosis of Celiac Disease (niddk.nih.gov) · MedlinePlus: Taking warfarin; Heart failure: fluids and diuretics; Prednisone (medlineplus.gov)